

Development of Managerial Capabilities

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México

Licenciatura en Administración

Instructor: Dr. Maggie Sloan	Email: maggie.sloan@gmail.com
Office Hours: by appointment	Class: Tuesday – Thursday, 7 – 8.30 am

Course Description

Your success in the working world depends in a large part on your ability to communicate ideas and arguments effectively. This class will help students to develop the communication skills necessary for successful business communication, focusing primarily on their public speaking and presentation skills. Developing these managerial skills will help students to achieve success in their careers at ITAM and beyond.

Students will develop these analytical and communication skills through written assignments, in-class discussion, individual and group presentations, and role-playing exercises. In addition, this course will pay particular attention to preparing ITAM students for the challenges they will face in the English-speaking business world.

Course Goals

This course is designed to function as not only a lecture but also a workshop and seminar. The goals for this course are learning-centered and designed to provide students with the tools necessary to be successful managers and leaders in the English-language business world. By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- analyze their own methods of communication and generate personal strategies for strengthening those communication skills
- deliver a successful oral presentation in English
- analyze the elements of an oral presentation and use this analysis to give specific, constructive feedback to peers
- develop analytical and critical skills and demonstrate these skills during class discussion, written work, oral presentations, and exams
- identify the elements of successful self-presentation and to demonstrate this knowledge by presenting themselves professionally and coherently in a cv, cover letter, and job interview
- work effectively in peer groups to achieve course goals

Course Texts

Required:

- Minto, Barbara. *The Pyramid Principle: Logic in Writing and Thinking*. (on reserve at ITAM library; selections available at Copy Cat)
- Munter, Mary. *Guide to Managerial Communication*. (available in library, via purchase, or via Kindle)
- Selected articles and cases available through link on comunidad or through EBSCO.

In order to have productive and engaging discussion, **students are expected to have completed all assigned readings before class** and to bring the readings (in print or electronic form) with them to class.

Pre-requisites

- Intermediate English

Grade

Your final grade will be comprised of the following elements:

- | | |
|-------------------------------|------|
| ▪ Participation and Homework | 25 % |
| ▪ Presentations | 65 % |
| Individual Presentations: 30% | |
| Group presentations: 35% | |
| ▪ Final Exam | 10 % |

Failure of any portion of the grade (i.e. homework and written assignments, first individual presentation, etc.) will lower your grade and may result in failing the course. **If you fail the final exam, you will fail the course.** All students must complete the group diary (assignment to be explained in class) in order to pass the class. You must pass the final exam to pass the course. The final exam will be cumulative. Additionally, **you must attend at least 80% of the class sessions in order to be able to take the final exam.**

Class Attendance and Participation

Because much of the learning of this class takes place during class discussion, class attendance and active participation—contributing as both a listener and a discussant—is mandatory. In-class work and assignments cannot be made up, and students are responsible for obtaining materials and information distributed in class. Absence during an exam or presentation will result in a failing grade.

- **You must attend at least 80% of the class sessions in order to be able to take the final exam.** Missing 20% or more of the classes will result in failing the attendance/participation portion of the grade and/or failing the class itself.
- Your attendance and participation grade will evaluate your *active* participation in class, your attendance, and your commitment to the class (arriving on time, participating actively, completing assignments, communicating with the professor in a responsible manner, and otherwise being an engaged and responsible student). Please notify me in advance if any circumstances will keep you from meeting your attendance or other requirements.
- Class begins at 7am, and you are late if you are not in the classroom when I take attendance. At 7.15am, the class is closed; any students not present will be marked absent. The first time in the semester that a student arrives more than 15 minutes late, he will be allowed to enter and will not be marked as absent, but each student is allowed only one free pass a semester.
- **Please turn off your cell phone and put it away. Using it in class is rude.** If you use your cell phone or your laptop while other students are presenting, you will receive a grade of 0 on your own presentation. (If there is an emergency reason why you need to check your phone during class, please let me know before class.)

- The official language of the classroom is English. I am happy to discuss any questions or concerns you might have in Spanish after class, but in order to best meet the course objectives I ask that no Spanish be spoken within the classroom.

Self-evaluations and Peer Feedback

Part of the process of improving our presentation skills (or really any skill) is reflecting critically on our preparation and performance and considering what we did well and what we can change. After each presentation, you will email me a self-evaluation of at least 1-2 paragraphs analysing qualitatively your presentation (within the body of the email is fine, unless you would like to create a separate document). You should focus on what you (and your group, if applicable) did that was effective in preparation and in presenting, and what you will focus on improving in the future. This self-evaluation will not receive a grade, but it is required because it is an important part of the learning process in this course. Additionally, you will be asked to give informal and formal feedback to classmates as part of the same process.

Academic Integrity

It is expected that all students will support the ideal of academic integrity and that they will be responsible for the integrity of their work. Plagiarism is academic theft. It is the representation of another's ideas or words as your own. Submitting work that you have written for another class is also considered plagiarism. Plagiarism and cheating are violations of university policy; they are serious offenses and bear serious consequences.

Knowing when and how to cite sources can be confusing. Learning how to incorporate outside materials into one's writing effectively and appropriately is a crucial skill that we will be developing in this course. If you are unsure whether you need to cite a source, please do not hesitate to ask me. Plagiarism by accident or mistake is still plagiarism (and will be punished as such), so please see me if you have any questions about how to cite sources.

En caso que el alumno sea encontrado cometiendo una práctica fraudulenta, se calificará la materia como no acreditada (N.A.), y la notificación correspondiente será incluida en el expediente del alumno (Artículo No. 29 del Reglamento de Alumnos de Estudios Profesionales).

Schedule of Topics and Readings – Fall 2014

Assignments are to be completed by the date indicated. Please bring assigned readings to class.

* This syllabus, like all things in life, is subject to change.

Introduction to Communication Strategies:

January 17	▪ Introduction to the Course ▪ Expectations for written work ▪ Presentation Activity	
January 19	▪ Explain presentation analysis assignment ▪ Communicator Strategy ▪ Audience Strategy ▪ Introduction to First Individual Presentation	▪ Read: Munter, Chapter 1: Communication Strategy ▪ Due: Letter of introduction (please email)
January 24	▪ Message Strategy ▪ Culture Strategy ▪ Form groups for class group work ▪ Sign up for 1st Individual Presentation	▪ Due: Letter of introduction (please email)

Structure and Persuasion of Arguments: Theory and Practice

January 26	▪ <i>The Pyramid Principle</i>, Barbara Minto ▪ Building the Pyramid ▪ Introductions: Situation, Complication, Question	▪ Minto: selections available at Copy Center
January 31	▪ Explanation of group projects ▪ Teamwork exercise ▪ Minto In-Class Presentations	▪ Read: MIT Teamwork Basics (available online)
February 2	No class meeting – class time will be made up during individual feedback meetings the week of February 28	▪ Use class meeting time to work on group presentations ▪ Read Munter, Chapters 2-4, in preparation for group presentation
February 7	▪ Speaking: Verbal Structure ▪ Speaking: Non-Verbal Skills	▪ Read: Munter, Chapter 5: Speaking: Verbal Structure; Chapter 7: Speaking: Non-Verbal Skills
February 9	▪ Discussion of “Learning Charisma”	▪ Read “Learning Charisma” ▪ Prepare Individual Presentations

	▪ Using transitions while speaking ▪ Transition exercise	
February 14	▪ Evaluated Group Presentation: “Harnessing the Science of Persuasion”	▪ Read: Robert Cialdini, “Harnessing the science of Persuasion”*
February 16	▪ Feedback on Group Presentations (in class) ▪ Introductions	▪ Due: self-evaluation ▪ Prepare Group Presentations
February 21	▪ Individual Presentations	▪ Prepare Individual Presentations
February 23	▪ Individual Presentations	▪ Prepare Individual Presentations ▪ Due: self-evaluation of individual presentation
February 28	▪ Individual meetings for feedback on Individual Presentations; no general class meeting	▪ Work on Group Presentations ▪ Due: self-evaluation of individual presentation
March 2	▪ Speaking: Using Visual Aids	▪ Read: Munter, Chapter 6: Speaking: Visual Aids ▪ Work in groups on group assignment
March 7	▪ Group Presentation	▪ Work on Group Presentations
March 9	▪ Feedback on Group Presentation	▪ Due: self-evaluation of group presentation and group dynamics
March 14	▪ Women and leadership: discussion and in-class debate	▪ Read: “Women and the Labyrinth of Leadership” (Eagly & Carli)* ▪ Readings from McKinsey (available on course website) ▪ Optional: Why Women Still Can’t Have It All (available on course website)
March 16	▪ Proposals for change: group presentations	▪ Prepare group presentation
March 21	▪ Giving feedback	▪ “Managing Interpersonal Feedback” (Barnes)*
March 23	▪ Authentic Leadership ▪ Introduction Exercise	▪ Read: “Discovering Your Authentic Leadership” (Bill George)*
March 28	▪ Final Group Project: 1st	▪ Prepare Final Group Projects

	Presentation	
March 30	▪ Feedback on Presentations	▪ Due: self-evaluation

Entering the Workplace and Communication in the Workplace:

April 4	▪ CV, Resumes, and cover letters ▪ Social media, privacy, and image control	▪ Read handouts and linked articles (available on course comunidad website) on preparing your cv and cover letter ▪ Read: “Hiring for Emotional Intelligence” (Bielaszka-DuVernay)*
April 6	▪ CV and Resumes ▪ Job Interviews	▪ Due: Rough draft of your cv/resume in English (<u>bring 2 hard copies to class</u>)
April 18	▪ Mock Job Interviews	▪ Prepare answers to practice interview questions
April 20	▪ Discussion and presentation: “Sunk in Sacramento”	▪ Due: Read and prepare “Sunk in Sacramento”

Final Presentations and Conclusions:

April 25	▪ Final Group Project: Final Presentations	▪ Prepare Final Group Presentations
April 27	▪ Feedback on Final Group Presentations	▪ Due: self-evaluation ▪ Prepare Individual Presentations
May 2	▪ Final Individual Presentations	▪ Prepare Individual Presentations
May 4	▪ Final Individual Presentations	▪ Prepare Individual Presentations ▪ Due: self-evaluation
May 9	▪ Final Individual Presentations	▪ Prepare Individual Presentations ▪ Due: self-evaluation
May 11	▪ Final Individual Presentations	▪ Prepare Individual Presentations ▪ Due: self-evaluation
May 16	▪ Final Individual Presentations	▪ Prepare Individual Presentations ▪ Due: self-evaluation ▪ Due: Final CV and cover letter
May 18	▪ Feedback on Final Individual Presentations and Final Thoughts	▪ Due: self-evaluation of individual presentation